👩‍🏫 Staff Guide · Health · Unit 3 Substance Use & Abuse (Level 3)

Level 3 = students who can work close to the gen ed lesson. No slide decks: students follow Mr. Finstuen's lesson with Level 3 readings and guided notes (both have a 🔊 read-aloud copy online).

1. How the pieces line up

Gen ed lesson	Level 3 piece
Substance Use & Abuse Vocabulary; Brain Development; Progression of Use	Reading paragraphs 1-2; notes part A
Stages of Change; Risk and Protective Factors	Reading paragraphs 2-3; notes part B (Sam scenario, never the student)
Alcohol; Opioids & Fentanyl; Naloxone & Good Samaritan Law	Reading paragraphs 3-4; notes part C
Evaluating Sources (CRAAP); School Substance Policy; Substance Use Quiz	Reading paragraph 5; notes part C; quick check

2. Supports built in

- Reading + notes have a 🔊 read-aloud copy online
- Tables can be filled with a word bank from the reading
- Person-first language in all talk

3. What to grade

- Quick check stands in for the Substance Use Quiz
- Notes stand in for the stages-of-change and factors worksheets
- Modified grading only as the IEP allows. Check with the case manager.

4. Who to ask

- Mr. Driver (SLE): changes and IEP questions.
- Facts we could not confirm say “check with Mr. Finstuen”.

🚧 Under construction (check with Mr. Finstuen)

- **School substance policy scenarios (zero-tolerance vs. restorative)**: His policy scenario sheet is not in the export; we only teach the two policy words.
- **Substance Use research slide (student-chosen drug)**: Turned in through an outside tool; the template is not in the export.
- **Guest speaker / recovery video notes**: Video titles and times are not in the export.

💗 Sensitive topic note

Some students have family members who use substances or are in recovery, and some may use themselves. Use person-first words (a person with a substance use disorder, not an addict). Never ask a student about their own or their family's use. Risk and protective factors are sorted for a made-up character, not the student. If a student shares something worrying, tell Mr. Driver and the school counselor. Crisis help: call or text 988; in an emergency call 911.

5. Photo credits (open licenses)

🧠 Substance Use & Abuse: Guided Notes

Health · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with the Substance Use and Abuse module (Vocabulary, Progression, Stages of Change, Risk/Protective Factors, Fentanyl, CRAAP, Policy)

Name: _____

Use the class slides and your reading. Key words:

substance · *prefrontal cortex* · *experimentation* · *progression* · *stages of change* · *relapse* · *risk factor* · *protective factor* · *opioid* · *fentanyl* · *overdose* · *naloxone* · *Good Samaritan law* · *person-first language* · *CRAAP test*

A. The brain and progression

1. The part of the brain for decisions, the _____, finishes developing around age _____.

2. Fill in the table.

Stage of use	What it looks like
Experimentation	
Mild	
Moderate	
Severe	

B. Stages of change and factors

3. Fill in the table.

Stage	Example (quitting vaping)
Pre-contemplation	
Contemplation	
Preparation	
Action	
Maintenance	

4. Sam is 15. Sam's older cousin vapes, Sam feels stressed about grades, Sam plays basketball and is close to a coach. List Sam's risk factors and protective factors.

_____

_____

_____

C. Safety and sources

5. Your friend at a party won't wake up and their lips look blue. List what you do, in order.

6. Use CRAAP to judge a website selling 'safe natural vapes' written by the company. Which letter fails and why?

🧠 Substance Use & Abuse: Reading

Health · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with the Substance Use and Abuse module (Vocabulary, Progression, Stages of Change, Risk/Protective Factors, Fentanyl, CRAAP, Policy)

Name: _____

Substances, the Brain and Making Safe Choices

A substance is anything that changes your mood or mind. Alcohol, nicotine, cannabis, opioids and stimulants are all substances. The human brain keeps developing until about age 25, and the prefrontal cortex, which controls decisions, planning and self-control, finishes last. Substance use during the teen years can change how the developing brain works and raises the risk of addiction.

Use often follows a progression: experimentation (trying it), mild use, moderate use (when use starts causing problems) and severe use (when it is hard to stop and it takes over parts of life). People who decide to change often move through the stages of change: pre-contemplation, contemplation, preparation, action and maintenance. Relapse, going back to using, is common and does not mean failure; a person can start the stages again.

Risk factors make harm more likely, and protective factors lower it. They can be biological (family history, age of first use), psychological (stress, trauma, coping skills) and social (friends who use, caring adults, school activities). Alcohol causes about 178,000 deaths in the U.S. each year. U.S. overdose deaths fell from 81,313 in 2024 to 69,973 in 2025, and most involve fentanyl.

Fentanyl is a very strong opioid. It is often pressed into fake pills that look like real medicine, and a tiny amount can cause an overdose. Signs of an opioid overdose include not waking up, slow or no breathing and blue or gray lips. Call 911, give naloxone (Narcan) if it is available, and stay with the person. Washington's Good Samaritan law protects people who call for help during an overdose from being charged for small amounts of drugs.

Information about drugs online is not always true. The CRAAP test checks a source: Currency (is it recent?), Relevance (does it answer my question?), Authority (who wrote it?), Accuracy (is it supported by evidence?) and Purpose (why was it made?). Words matter too: person-first language, such as “a person with a substance use disorder,” reduces shame and helps people ask for help.

Check your reading

1. Why are teens at higher risk from substance use than adults?

2. What are three signs of an opioid overdose, and what should you do?

3. Why does the Good Samaritan law exist?

🧠 Substance Use & Abuse: Quick Check

Health · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with the Substance Use and Abuse module (Vocabulary, Progression, Stages of Change, Risk/Protective Factors, Fentanyl, CRAAP, Policy)

Name: _____

Multiple choice and short answer. You may have it read aloud.

1. The brain develops until about age…

A. 14 | B. 18 | C. 25

2. Setting a quit date is which stage of change?

A. Preparation | B. Contemplation | C. Maintenance

3. Which is a protective factor?

A. Friends who use | B. Easy access | C. A caring adult

4. Naloxone is used to…

A. Reverse an opioid overdose | B. Treat a cold | C. Stop vaping

5. Explain why fake pills are so dangerous right now.

6. Rewrite with person-first language: “That addict needs help.”

🧠 Substance Use & Abuse: Guided Notes · ANSWER KEY

Health · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with the Substance Use and Abuse module (Vocabulary, Progression, Stages of Change, Risk/Protective Factors, Fentanyl, CRAAP, Policy)

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A. The brain and progression

1. The part of the brain for decisions, the **prefrontal cortex**, finishes developing around age **25**.

2. Fill in the table.

Stage of use	What it looks like
Experimentation	**trying it**
Mild	**occasional use, few problems**
Moderate	**use starts causing problems**
Severe	**hard to stop; takes over life**

B. Stages of change and factors

3. Fill in the table.

Stage	Example (quitting vaping)
Pre-contemplation	**doesn't think vaping is a problem**
Contemplation	**thinks about quitting**
Preparation	**sets a quit date**
Action	**stops vaping**
Maintenance	**stays vape-free for months**

4. Sam is 15. Sam's older cousin vapes, Sam feels stressed about grades, Sam plays basketball and is close to a coach. List Sam's risk factors and protective factors.

Risk: cousin vapes, stress. Protective: basketball, caring coach.

C. Safety and sources

5. Your friend at a party won't wake up and their lips look blue. List what you do, in order.

Call 911; give naloxone if available; try to keep them breathing / on their side; stay with them. The Good Samaritan law protects you.

6. Use CRAAP to judge a website selling 'safe natural vapes' written by the company. Which letter fails and why?

Purpose and Authority: it is written by a seller to make money, not an expert.

🔑 *Key written by our team from Mr. Finstuen's worksheets and slides, please check.*

🧠 Substance Use & Abuse: Quick Check · ANSWER KEY

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1. The brain develops until about age…

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A. Friends who use | B. Easy access | **C. A caring adult**

4. Naloxone is used to…

A. Reverse an opioid overdose | B. Treat a cold | C. Stop vaping

5. Explain why fake pills are so dangerous right now.

They can contain fentanyl, which looks like real medicine and a tiny amount can cause a deadly overdose.

6. Rewrite with person-first language: “That addict needs help.”

That person with a substance use disorder needs help.

🔑 *Written by our team from Mr. Finstuen's lessons and quizzes, please check.*